Madurai later in the day to take me to Madurai as soon as I disembarked at Madras from the regular Indian Airlines flight, which was leaving Delhi in an hour's time. Dr Arunachalam told me, "You have earned this for your hard work of the last six months."

Flying towards Madras, I scribbled on the back of my boarding pass:

Who never climbed the weary league –
Can such a foot explore
The purple territories
On Rameswaram's shore?

The Air Force helicopter landed close to the Indian Airlines aircraft as soon as it arrived from Delhi. Within the next few minutes I was on my way to Madurai. The Air Force commandant there was kind enough to take me to the railway station, where the train to Rameswaram was just about to rol out of the platform. I was in Rameswaram wel in time for Zameela's wedding. I blessed my brother's daughter with a father's love.

The Defence Minister put up our proposal before the Cabinet and saw it through. His recommendations on our proposal were accepted and an unprecedented amount of